

PRESS KIT

C.H.A.I.S.E.S.

The Social Geometry of the Luxembourg Gardens

20 – 22 October 2026

Opening Tuesday 20 October, 5 – 8pm

24 rue Chapon, 75003 Paris

Le Marais • Free entry



Sculpture • Painting • Drawing • Sound • Installation

Six artists

Jimmy Gardner • Allard van Hoorn • Quinn Lewis

Wayne Pate • Jessica Anne Schwartz • Charlotte Tapol

A project by Jimmy Gardner • Creative direction Allard van Hoorn

Produced by the New to the Wall Foundation

lachaiseparisienne.com • [@new.to.the.wall.art](https://www.instagram.com/new.to.the.wall.art)

Every morning the chairs go back to the grid. Every evening, Paris redraws them.

From 20 to 22 October 2026 the New to the Wall Foundation presents *C.H.A.I.S.E.S. — The Social Geometry of the Luxembourg Gardens*, a three-day installation in the Marais that translates the silent choreography of the Luxembourg's green chairs into sculpture, painting, drawing, sound and installation. Opening Tuesday 20 October, 5–8pm, on the eve of Art Basel Paris's VIP days. Free entry.

Every morning a gardener in the Jardin du Luxembourg resets the green metal chairs into a neutral grid. Over the day, Paris redraws them: two chairs that draw close and then drift apart, a single chair tracking the sun, a reader keeping an arm's length of distance, a group forming for lunch. Nobody directs this choreography. Almost nobody sees it.

C.H.A.I.S.E.S. puts it in a room. Four scenarios observed in the garden over a year — the sun-worshipper, the lovers' spat, the reader, the gathering — are captured as choreographic data (proximity, orientation, velocity, stillness, sounds) and translated by six artists into sculpture, paintings, drawings, kinetic scrolls, a sound performance played on an actual chair from the garden, and an installation that holds them all together in a room in the 3rd arrondissement.

"I noticed the chairs grouped in these little settings, and it hit me that they were a reflection of our society, of our humanity. How did they get like that? Then I started thinking about the chairs as data — vectors, trajectories. Everything followed from there."

Jimmy Gardner, originator of the project and co-founder of the New to the Wall Foundation

The project is directed by Dutch, Paris-based artist and composer Allard van Hoorn, whose *Urban Songlines* have been shown at Tate St Ives, the Whitney Museum, MAAT Lisbon and the Van Abbemuseum. Jimmy Gardner shows four sculptures, one per scenario; he is joined by artists Quinn Lewis, Charlotte Tampol, Jessica Anne Schwartz and Wayne Pate, who drew the project's emblem.

"The chairs have knowledge gathered over many years of usage — they are collective repositories of meaning that live in symbiosis with humans and practice slowness through continuous exchange — they radiate histories into the now, from seat-level."

Allard van Hoorn, creative director, sound and installation

From 6 October, miniature Luxembourg chairs — 3D-printed from the original, tube by tube — leave the studio and are left around Paris: on ledges, on café tables, in the garden where they were born. Each carries a QR code in a pocket under its seat. Whoever finds one keeps it, and reports where it now lives. The movement of the chairs, which has always reflected society, breaks out of the park and the exhibition into the city.

C.H.A.I.S.E.S. — The Social Geometry of the Luxembourg Gardens

Opening Tuesday 20 October 2026, 5–8pm · Wednesday 21 and Thursday 22 October, noon–8pm (closing evening Thursday 5–8pm)

New to the Wall Foundation — project space, 24 rue Chapon, 75003 Paris · Métro Arts et Métiers / Rambuteau · Free entry

lachaiseparisienne.com · Instagram @new.to.the.wall.art · #parischaise

Press contact: Jimmy Gardner · jimmy@newtothewall.com · +1 202 570 3001 · HD images available on request



Readers by the Grand Bassin, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026. © New to the Wall Foundation

One observation, six artists

The observation

The chairs of the Jardin du Luxembourg are free. People move them, turn them, pull them together or apart, and every day the garden becomes a map of the connections between the people in it: conversations, arguments, solitudes, reunions. The next morning the grid erases everything and the day begins again.

For a year, Jimmy Gardner watched these formations. Four of them kept returning; they became the project's four scenarios.

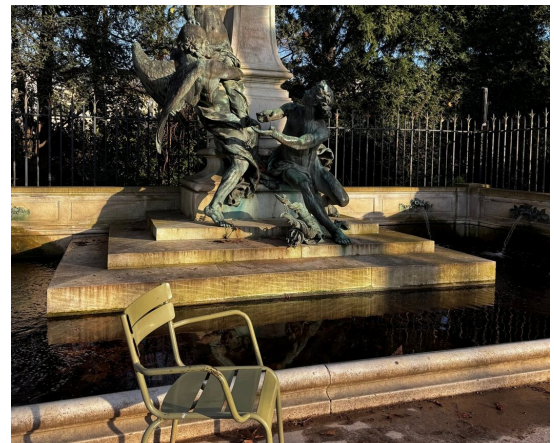
The translation

Rather than tracking real chairs individually by GPS, C.H.A.I.S.E.S. works from the higher level of abstraction of the four human scenarios. Those scenarios and their artifacts — movement, sound and emotion — inspire and inform the work: the same afternoon becomes a sculpture, a painting, a drawing, an instrumental voice.

The project draws on the analytical framework of William Forsythe's *One Flat Thing, reproduced* and Ohio State University's *Synchronous Objects*, which decomposed a single dance into dozens of visual, spatial and data-driven readings — extended here from the stage to the public garden, from professional dancers to the everyday choreography of social life.



Two chairs face to face, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026. © New to the Wall Foundation



A chair at the fountain, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026. © New to the Wall Foundation

The four scenarios



01 • Sun-Worshipping

A solitary figure tracks the light, making slow angular adjustments as the sun crosses the garden.



02 • Lover's Spat

Two chairs begin entwined, drift apart through tension, orbit in conflict, and either reconcile or leave.



03 • The Reader

Deliberate isolation. The chair positions itself away from traffic, creates a buffer zone, and barely moves all afternoon.



04 • The Gathering

Strands that never touch and never separate — a group holding an uncanny synchrony across the day: exchange, learning, the dynamics of a crowd.

Jimmy Gardner, *Sun-Worshippers*, *Lover's Spat*, *The Reader*, *The Gathering*, 2026, renderings of the bronze edition. © NTTW Foundation

Six artists, one foundation

Jimmy Gardner

ORIGINATOR, SCULPTURE

Collector, entrepreneur and co-founder of the New to the Wall Foundation, dividing his time between the Hudson Valley and Paris. His year of watching the Luxembourg's chairs is where the project began; he is its sixth artist, showing four sculptures, one per scenario.

Four 3D-printed sculptures, one per scenario: *Sun-Worshippers*, *The Reader*, *Lover's Spat*, *The Gathering*. Each vertical strand is one chair's afternoon — every drift, every fidget, every retreat, drawn as a line you can hold. The bottom of the strand is early afternoon; the top is evening. The octagonal plinth is the garden itself: the gravel, the raked allées, even the corner of the Grand Bassin, incised exactly where they lie in the Luxembourg. Exhibition prints in PLA, edition of 5 + 1 AP; each work is also cast in bronze (lost-wax, same size, edition of 5 + 1 AP, to order). Around 33 cm high.



Jimmy Gardner, the four sculptures, 2026, renderings of the bronze edition (lost-wax, 5 + 1 AP), c. 33 cm. © NTTW Foundation



Jimmy Gardner, *Sun-Worshippers* and *The Gathering*, 2026, renderings of the bronze edition, c. 33 cm. © NTTW Foundation

Allard van Hoorn

CREATIVE DIRECTOR, SOUND, INSTALLATION

Dutch artist and composer (b. 1968), based in Paris. His practice, centred on the collaborative *Urban Songlines* series, translates public spaces into sound; his work has been shown at Tate St Ives, the Whitney Museum of American Art, MAAT Lisbon and the Van Abbemuseum, Eindhoven. For C.H.A.I.S.E.S. he is creative director, scenographer and composer. allardvanhoorn.com

Sound performance

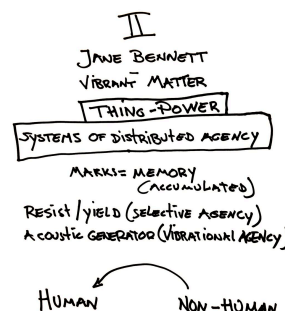
During the exhibition a Sénat chair, on loan from the Luxembourg Gardens, is performed as an instrument activated by earth magnets and a resonator: *FERROUS*, a spinning magnetic polyphonic string resonator by Landscape. The sound releases the collective memory of the chair as an audible score that is further built into an ambient composition for the gallery. The walls are lined with a manifesto — an ode to chairs and their collective slowness. His working notes call on Jane Bennett (*Vibrant Matter*) and Wolfgang Ernst: chairs as an involuntary, distributed archive; sonification as the translation of texture into audible form; slowness as a way of honouring time.

Installation

The room itself: chairs, kinetic scrolls, sound and projection arranged so visitors walk into the geometry instead of looking at it.



The Sénat chair for Allard van Hoorn's sound performance, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026 — chaise prêtée par le jardin du Luxembourg-Sénat. © Allard van Hoorn



Allard van Hoorn, working notes (II · Jane Bennett, *Vibrant Matter*), 2026. Right: *FERROUS*, spinning magnetic polyphonic string resonator by Landscape — the sonic activator for the Sénat chair. © Allard van Hoorn

Charlotte Tampol

PAINTING

Brooklyn-based multidisciplinary artist working in oil painting, printmaking, photography and tattoo. Her work explores femininity and Filipino tattoo culture. @charlottetampolart

Reliquary of Touch (Moment One) and *(Moment Two)*, 2026: a diptych about the residual energy held within the chairs. In the first panel a couple shares a kiss, their chairs turned to face each other; their knees touch, as do the legs of the chairs. In the second the couple has gone, but the chairs remain in loving embrace, a purse left on one seat. As we move the chairs for our needs, the artist writes, “we become temporary orchestrators of fate for the lives of each chair.” Acrylic and oil on canvas, 61 × 91.5 cm (24 × 36 in) each.



Charlotte Tampol, *Reliquary of Touch (Moment One)* and *(Moment Two)*, 2026, acrylic and oil on canvas, 61 × 91.5 cm each. © the artist

Wayne Pate

PAINTING, EMBLEM

Self-taught Brooklyn painter, working in acrylic since 1992. Represented by Armature Projects (New York), The Finch Project (London / Bath) and Tourrette (Paris). He has lived in Paris and spent many hours in the Jardin du Luxembourg. Creator of the C.H.A.I.S.E.S. emblem. waynepate.com

rendez-vous avec une chaise no. 1–3, 2026: three works in acrylic scratching on brown laid paper (21 × 29.5 cm). “The chair supports your moment of contemplation”; “The chair is just as enraptured as the reader”; “The chair anxiously awaits the outcome — will there be an encore?” From years of sitting in the Luxembourg’s chairs, Pate draws “the brief morphing of the individual and the object”, in the Parisian idiom of posted bills and wall art. *Une chaise vous attend*. Pate also drew the project’s emblem.



Wayne Pate, *rendez-vous avec une chaise* no. 1, 2 and 3, 2026, acrylic scratching on brown laid paper, 21 × 29.5 cm. © Wayne Pate



Wayne Pate, C.H.A.I.S.E.S. emblem, 2026, white line on black, kraft paper (scan). © Wayne Pate

Jessica Anne Schwartz

DRAWING, SYNAESTHESIA

New York and Paris-based artist whose practice spans more than three decades. Widely exhibited and held in private and public collections, her work across drawing, painting, sculpture and land-based installation explores sensory perception rooted in a lifelong experience of synaesthesia. jessicaanneschwartz.com

In 2023 Schwartz spent a year returning to the chairs of the Luxembourg Gardens, using them as a fixed listening post. Her *Jardin du Luxembourg Synaesthesia Drawings* are sensory recordings of the gardens' living soundscape — the choreography of the Sénat chairs, children at play, footsteps on gravel, the rustle of newspapers and picnic lunches, birdsong, wind through the trees, sun and rain. Each mark in colour and form corresponds to a specific sonic cue; she describes “butterfly-netting” the most beautiful-looking sounds and pinning them to paper. Twelve drawings from the series are on view: sumi ink, walnut ink, mica and hand-mixed gouache on heirloom Murillo paper, 49.5 × 35.6 cm.



Jessica Anne Schwartz, from *Jardin du Luxembourg Synaesthesia Drawings*, 2023, 49.5 × 35.6 cm. © Jessica Anne Schwartz

Quinn Lewis

KINETIC SCULPTURE, DRAWING

Multidisciplinary artist based in Brooklyn. Lewis finds complexity in the mundane, highlighting significance in common objects and routine through careful observation and personification. Drawing on an interest in simple machines and sequential storytelling, he combines sculpture and animation to create layered, kinetic apparatuses. A Bard College graduate, he is pursuing work in printmaking and animation.

Quinn Lewis looks at the assemblies of chairs visitors leave behind. *Chairs Under Sun* and *Chairs Under Shade* are life drawings made in the garden in July (ink and coloured pencil on kraft paper, 14.8 × 21 cm): each configuration is fixed by its shadow, grounded in the moment it was observed. The three *Kinetic Scrolls* (no. 1–3, 61 × 48 × 15 cm) carry them into interaction: over a painted scene of chairs at morning, afternoon or evening, the viewer winds scrolls of garden visitors, drawn in graphite on muslin and driven by roller chain, composing their own combinations of gestures, bodies, objects and uses.



Quinn Lewis with a *Kinetic Scroll*, studio, Brooklyn, 2026. Photo courtesy the artist



Quinn Lewis, *Chairs Under Sun* No. 1 and *Chairs Under Shade* No. 1, 2026, ink and coloured pencil on kraft paper. © the artist

Three days in the Marais

Tuesday 20 October	Opening, 5–8pm
Wednesday 21 October	Open to the public, noon–8pm
Thursday 22 October	Open to the public, noon–8pm · closing evening 5–8pm
Venue	New to the Wall Foundation — project space 24 rue Chapon, 75003 Paris
Getting there	Métro Arts et Métiers (3, 11), Rambuteau (11) · Bus 20, 38, 47
Admission	Free, no booking required
Press	Preview visits by appointment on Monday 19 and Tuesday 20 October, afternoons · Interviews with Jimmy Gardner and Allard van Hoorn on request
Online	lachaiseparisienne.com · Instagram @new.to.the.wall.art · #parischaise #youfoundachaise

Press contact

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The exhibition opens on the eve of Art Basel Paris's VIP days (Grand Palais, 21–25 October) and on the opening day of Paris Internationale.

New to the Wall Foundation

A private foundation that collects, exhibits and supports contemporary artists through commissions and cross-disciplinary projects. Founded by Jimmy Gardner and Shana Glickfield, it is based in New York's Hudson Valley and works between New York and Paris. C.H.A.I.S.E.S. is its first Paris exhibition; 24 rue Chapon is its temporary project space for the occasion.

The foundation invests in artists and their community and expects no return. The artists keep 100% of the proceeds of anything they sell. All revenue from Jimmy Gardner's sculptures is fed back into supporting emerging artists — residencies, virtual residencies, commissions.

Available images

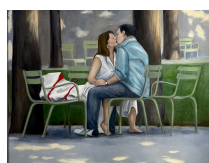
Free for press use in connection with the exhibition, with credit. HD files: jimmy@newtothewall.com. Also available: the four bronze renderings individually, all three of Wayne Pate's *rendez-vous*, further drawings by Quinn Lewis and Jessica Anne Schwartz.



1 · Wayne Pate, C.H.A.I.S.E.S. emblem, 2026, white line on black, kraft paper (scan). © Wayne Pate



2 · Jimmy Gardner, the four sculptures, 2026, renderings of the bronze edition (lost-wax, 5 + 1 AP), c. 33 cm. © NTTW Foundation



3 · Charlotte Tapol, Reliquary of Touch (Moment One), 2026, acrylic and oil on canvas, 61 × 91.5 cm. © the artist



4 · Charlotte Tapol, Reliquary of Touch (Moment Two), 2026, acrylic and oil on canvas, 61 × 91.5 cm. © the artist



5 · Wayne Pate, rendez-vous avec une chaise no. 1, 2026, acrylic scratching on brown laid paper, 21 × 29.5 cm. © Wayne Pate



6 · Wayne Pate, rendez-vous avec une chaise no. 2, 2026, acrylic scratching on brown laid paper, 21 × 29.5 cm. © Wayne Pate



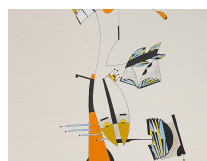
7 · Quinn Lewis, Chairs Under Sun No. 1, 2026, ink and coloured pencil on kraft paper, 14.8 × 21 cm. © the artist



8 · Quinn Lewis with a Kinetic Scroll, studio, Brooklyn, 2026. Photo courtesy the artist



9 · Jessica Anne Schwartz, from Jardin du Luxembourg Synaesthesia Drawings, 2023, 49.5 × 35.6 cm. © Jessica Anne Schwartz



10 · Jessica Anne Schwartz, from Jardin du Luxembourg Synaesthesia Drawings, 2023, 49.5 × 35.6 cm. © Jessica Anne Schwartz



11 · FERROUS, spinning magnetic polyphonic string resonator by Landscape — the sonic activator for the Sénat chair in Allard van Hoorn's sound performance, 2026. © Allard van Hoorn



12 · The Sénat chair for Allard van Hoorn's sound performance, Jardin du Luxembourg, 2026 — chaise prêtée par le jardin du Luxembourg-Sénat. © Allard van Hoorn